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HEAT STROKE

A WOMAN takes her infant for a swim at Sangam, the confluence of three rivers at Allahabad, to beat the heat. Temperatures crossed the 44-degree Celsius mark across north India as the monsoon seemed to have stalled just before hitting the west coast.

BHOPAL | Twisted Tale

Chief Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan has been quick to suspend Bhopal District Janpad Panchayat Chief Executive Officer Gyaneshwar Patil. A television sting had caught the IAS officer in a state of undress with Sikandarabad Village Panchayat Secretary Satish Chaukse, who alleges that Patil had been sodomising him repeatedly. Chaukse now claims that the police are soft-peddalling the case after Patil filed a complaint that he was trying to blackmail him. The medical report following an inquiry by the police has not shown any signs of forced sex. In support of Choukse, the state Panchayat Sachiv Sangathan has threatened to go on strike if Patil is not booked. On the other hand, the district panchayat staff held a day-long strike in support of Patil. The controversy comes at a time when the state is heading for panchayat elections later this year in which the powerful union of panchayat secretaries cannot be ignored.

by Ambresh Mishra

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